

CASE ID: 199211710220

EPISODE NAME: China Sanctions France for Arms Sales to Taiwan 1992

1992/11/29 - 1994/01/12

Sender: China (710)

Target: France (220)

Issue: End Weapons/Materials Proliferation (9)

Final Outcome: Total Acquiescence by Target State following sanctions imposition (7)

Summary:

On 1992/11/29, China threatened France that trade and diplomatic relations would suffer if it followed through on a deal to sell Taiwan 60 Mirage fighter jets.¹ After it became clear France planned to go forward with the sale, China ordered Paris to close its consulate in Guangzhou,² and barred French companies from working on a profitable subway project there.³ Relations were restored on 1994/01/12, marking the end of hostilities that began in 1989.⁴⁵

Narrative:

On 1992/09/10, French government sources announced that France was on the verge of a \$2.6 billion USD deal to sell Taiwan 60 Mirage fighter jets.⁶ Then, on 1992/11/29, China threatened France that trade and diplomatic relations would suffer if it followed through with the deal.⁷ China again threatened France with an unspecified retaliation, with Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Lin Jian saying, “On this issue of principle, our position is consistent,” on 1992/12/03.⁸

¹ “France warned on jet deal.” *Times of India*, November 29th, 1992.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/609415316/CBAB8ECAB5F14D76PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=News papers>.

² “China orders France to close consulate over Taiwan jets” *United Press International*, December 23rd, 1992.

<https://www.upi.com/Archives/1992/12/23/China-orders-France-to-close-consulate-over-Taiwan-jets/7165725086800/>.

³ Cohen, Roger. “France Bars Taiwan Sales, Warming China Ties.” *The New York Times*, January 13th, 1994.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/109320882/6E1BDF121D44448PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newspapers>.

⁴ *Ibid.*

⁵ “France May Sell Frigates to Taiwan.” *South China Morning Post*, December 30th, 1989.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/1540507138/526B7CABA9CA45A5PQ/4?accountid=14556&sourcetype=News papers>.

⁶ Cue, Eduardo. “France said to approve jet sale to Taiwan.” *UPI*, September 10th, 1992.

<https://www.upi.com/Archives/1992/09/10/France-said-to-approve-jet-sale-to-Taiwan/2466716097600/>.

⁷ “France warned on jet deal.” *Times of India*, November 29th, 1992.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/609415316/CBAB8ECAB5F14D76PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=News papers>.

⁸ Agence France Presse. “Attack on France for jet sales.” *South China Morning Post*, 4 Dec. 1992.

Before France could confirm the sale, China ordered France to close its consulate in Guangzhou on 1992/12/23,⁹ and formally barred French companies from bidding for subway contracts in the province worth \$1 billion USD.¹⁰ France officially confirmed the sale on 1993/01/08.¹¹

Initial reports suggested that these reprisals were seen as largely symbolic.¹² However, in 1993/11, the German government secured approximately \$4 billion in new contracts in China, including for the Guangzhou subway project, from which French companies were excluded.¹³ In the face of significant financial losses, French prime minister Edouard Balladur agreed to ban further arms sales to Taiwan in return for a restoration of diplomatic and trade relations on 1994/01/12.¹⁴

⁹ "China orders France to close consulate over Taiwan jets" *United Press International*, December 23rd, 1992. <https://www.upi.com/Archives/1992/12/23/China-orders-France-to-close-consulate-over-Taiwan-jets/7165725086800/>.

¹⁰ Cohen, Roger. "France Bars Taiwan Sales, Warming China Ties." *The New York Times*, January 13th, 1994. <https://www.proquest.com/docview/109320882/6E1BDF121D44448PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newspapers>.

¹¹ "France confirms sale of fighter jets to Taiwan." *Wall Street Journal*, January 8th, 1993. <https://www.proquest.com/docview/398318902/Record/2C57F48146A4254PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newspapers>.

¹² Ibid.

¹³ Cohen, Roger. "France Bars Taiwan Sales, Warming China Ties." *The New York Times*, January 13th, 1994. <https://www.proquest.com/docview/109320882/6E1BDF121D44448PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newspapers>.

¹⁴ Cohen, Roger. "France Bars Taiwan Sales, Warming China Ties." *The New York Times*, January 13th, 1994. <https://www.proquest.com/docview/109320882/6E1BDF121D44448PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newspapers>.